

University of South Florida

2025-2026 Graduate Catalog

About USF

- [Welcome to USF](#)
- [Accreditation](#)
- [Administration](#)
- [Campus Locations / Maps](#)
- [College Deans and Associate Deans](#)
- [Graduate Council](#)
- [Graduate Degrees Offered](#)
- [Majors, Concentrations, Graduate Certificates](#)
- [Mission and Goals](#)
- [Office of Graduate Studies Administration](#)
- [Office of Graduate Studies Directory](#)

Selected USF Policies and Resources

- [Campus Alcohol Beverages Policy](#)
- [Center for Career and Professional Development](#)
- [Center for Victim Advocacy and Violence Prevention](#)
- [Diversity and Equal Opportunity: Discrimination and Harassment](#)
- [Drug-Free Workplace/Schools Policy](#)
- [Office of Veteran Success](#)
- [Student Accessibility Services](#)
- [Student Ombuds Office](#)
- [Title IX Policy](#)
- [Tobacco and Smoke Free University](#)
- [University Libraries](#)

Welcome to the University of South Florida!

Founded in 1956, the University of South Florida is rich with tradition, known for our academic excellence, groundbreaking research, service to surrounding communities and wide-ranging student opportunities.

Situated in the vibrant Tampa Bay region with campuses in Tampa, [St. Petersburg](#) and [Sarasota-Manatee](#), USF serves nearly 50,000 students from almost 70 countries across our three branch campuses.

USF offers more than 200 programs from [14 colleges](#) including undergraduate majors, minors and concentrations as well as undergraduate, graduate, specialist and professional degrees.

Ranked among the top [50 public universities](#) in the U.S. for six years in a row (U.S. News & World Report), USF is also recognized as the [#1 "best value"](#) among all universities in Florida, public or private.

As a member of the [Association of American Universities \(AAU\)](#), USF is now among the top research schools in North America.

With a total annual [economic impact of \\$6.02 billion](#), USF supports 68,704 jobs in the state. Our faculty and students are working on real-world problems, conducting research that impacts and improves lives—locally and around the world.

As Tampa Bay's only academic medical center, [USF Health](#) is in partnership with the Morsani College of Medicine ([#1 in the state](#)), College of Nursing, College of Public Health, Taneja College of Pharmacy, School of Physical Therapy & Rehabilitation Sciences, Biomedical Sciences Graduate & Postdoctoral Programs, and USF Health's multispecialty physicians group.

Together, USF Health, in partnership with [Tampa General Hospital](#), continues to integrate education, research, and patient care, working toward our shared value: Making Life Better.

At USF, we believe every student will succeed if given the opportunity. Here students do more than attend class; they get involved, explore ideas, and prepare for their future.

From academic support to career planning, we help students reach their goals. We invite you to explore more about our university – in person and online – and discover how you can prosper at USF.

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[More USF facts.](#)

Campus Locations / Parking

USF is situated in the vibrant and diverse Tampa Bay region, with campuses in Tampa, St. Petersburg and Sarasota-Manatee. Together our campuses comprise more than 1,600 acres and nearly 12 million square feet of building space, with areas boasting coastal, bayfront and riverfront views.

For information about each USF campus, visit [Tampa](#), [St. Petersburg](#), or [Sarasota-Manatee](#).

TAMPA

University of South Florida
4202 E. Fowler Avenue
Tampa, FL 33620
(813) 974-2011
Website: <https://www.usf.edu>

[Campus Map](#)
[Parking Information](#)

SARASOTA-MANATEE

University of South Florida
5700 N. Tamiami Trail
Sarasota, FL 34243-2197
(941) 359-4200
Website: <https://www.sarasotamanatee.usf.edu/>

[Campus Map](#)
[Parking Information](#)

ST. PETERSBURG

University of South Florida
140 Seventh Avenue S.
St. Petersburg, FL 33701
(727) 873-1142
Website: <https://www.stpetersburg.usf.edu/>

[Campus Map](#)
[Parking Information](#)

Mission

Led by outstanding faculty and professional staff, the University of South Florida conducts innovative scholarship, creative activity and basic and translational research, and delivers a world-class educational experience promoting the success of our talented and diverse undergraduate, graduate, and professional students. As a public metropolitan research university, USF, in partnership with our communities, serves the people of Florida, the nation, and the world by fostering intellectual inquiry and outcomes that positively shape the future - regionally, nationally and globally.

Accreditation

The University of South Florida is accredited by the Southern Association of Colleges and Schools Commission on Colleges (SACSCOC) to award associate, baccalaureate, master's, educational specialist, and doctoral degrees. The University of South Florida may also offer credentials such as certificates and diplomas at approved degree levels. Questions about the accreditation of the University of South Florida may be directed in writing to the Southern Association of Colleges and Schools Commission on Colleges at 1866 Southern Lane, Decatur, GA 30033-4097, by calling (404) 679-4500, or by using information available on SACSCOC's website (www.sacscoc.org). The accreditation of this USF branch campus is a part of and depends on the continued accreditation of the University of South Florida.

Normal inquiries about the institution, such as admission requirements, financial aid, educational programs, etc., should be addressed directly to the institution and not to the Commission's office.

Learn more about USF's institutional [accreditation](#).

Graduate Degrees Offered by the University

Master's Degrees:

Master of Architecture	M.Arch.
Master of Arts	M.A.
Master of Arts in Teaching	M.A.T.
Master of Business Administration	M.B.A.
Master of Education	M.Ed.
Master of Fine Arts	M.F.A.
Master of Health Administration	M.H.A.
Master of Music	M.M.
Master of Physician Assistant Studies	M.P.A.S.
Master of Public Administration	M.P.A.
Master of Public Health	M.P.H.
Master of Science	M.S.
Master of Science in Accountancy and Analytics	M.S.A.A.
Master of Science in Aerospace Engineering	M.S.A.E.
Master of Science in Artificial Intelligence	M.S.A.I.
Master of Science in Bioinformatics and Computational Biology	M.S.B.C.B.
Master of Science in Biomedical Engineering	M.S.B.E.
Master of Science in Biotechnology	M.S.B.
Master of Science in Chemical Engineering	M.S.C.H.
Master of Science in Civil Engineering	M.S.C.E.
Master of Science in Computer Engineering	M.S.C.S.
Master of Science in Computer Science	M.S.C.P.
Master of Science in Cybersecurity	M.S.C.Y.S.
Master of Science in Data Intelligence	M.S.D.I.
Master of Science in Electrical Engineering	M.S.E.E.
Master of Science in Engineering Management	M.S.E.M.
Master of Science in Environmental Engineering	M.S.E.V.
Master of Science in Health Informatics	M.S.H.I.
Master of Science in Industrial Engineering	M.S.I.E.
Master of Science in Marketing	M.S.M.
Master of Science in Materials Science and Engineering	M.S.M.S.E.
Master of Science in Mechanical Engineering	M.S.M.E.
Master of Science in Medical Sciences	M.S.M.S.
Master of Science in Nursing	M.S.N.
Master of Science in Public Health	M.S.P.H.

Master of Social Work	M.S.W.
Master of Urban and Community Design	M.U.C.D.
Master of Urban and Regional Planning	M.U.R.P.

Advanced Graduate Degrees

Education Specialist	Ed.S.
Doctor of Business Administration	D.B.A.
Doctor of Education	Ed.D.
Doctor of Philosophy	Ph.D.
Doctor of Public Health	Dr.P.H.

Professional Degrees

Doctor of Audiology	Au.D.
Doctor of Medicine	M.D.
Doctor of Nursing Practice	D.N.P.
Doctor of Pharmacy	Pharm.D.
Doctor of Physical Therapy	D.P.T.

The University of South Florida and all colleges, departments and degree programs therein establish certain academic requirements that must be met before a degree is granted. These requirements concern such things as curricula and courses, majors and minors, and academic residence. Advisors, directors, department chairs, and deans are available to help the student understand and arrange to meet these requirements, but the student is responsible for fulfilling them. At the end of a student’s course of study, if the requirements for graduation have not been satisfied, the degree will not be granted. For this reason, it is important for all students to acquaint themselves with all regulations and to remain currently informed throughout their college careers and to be responsible for completing requirements. Courses, majors, and requirements described in the Catalog may be suspended, deleted, restricted, supplemented, or changed in any other manner at any time at the sole discretion of the University and the USF Board of Trustees.

Majors, Concentrations, Graduate Certificates (Authorized)

As of the date of this publication, the University is authorized to offer 48 different graduate degrees, with graduate majors authorized as listed here:

- [View Graduate Majors \(A-Z\)](#)
- [View list of Concentrations \(with Major/Degree\)](#)
- [View Graduate Certificates](#)

113	Total Graduate Certificates		
182	Total Graduate Majors	245	Total Concentrations
121	Master’s (including M.A., M.S., etc.)	162	Concentrations at the Master’s Level
3	Education Specialist (Ed.S.)	9	Concentrations at the Specialist Level
52	Doctoral (including Ph.D., Ed.D., DrPh., D.B.A., etc.)	68	Concentrations at the Doctoral Level
6	Professional Doctoral (including Au.D., D.N.P., M.D., D.P.T., PharmD)	6	Concentrations at the Professional Level

Administration

The University of South Florida is a member of the State University System (SUS) of Florida and is governed by the Florida Board of Governors and the University Board of Trustees.

Florida Board of Governors

For a current list of the Board of Governors (BOG), please refer to their website: <https://www.flbog.edu/about-us-2/>

University Board of Trustees

The [USF Board of Trustees](#) is the public body corporate of the University. It sets cost-effective policy for the institution and serves as the legal owner and governing board. The Board of Trustees is responsible for high quality education programs within the laws of the State of Florida and regulations of the Florida Board of Governors. It holds the institution's resources in trust and is responsible for their efficient and effective use as per Florida Statute 1.001 University Board of Trustees Powers and Duties.

The Board of Trustees is comprised of thirteen members, six who are appointed by the Florida Governor and five who are appointed by the Florida Board of Governors and confirmed by the Florida Senate for a term of five years. The elected Faculty Senate President and Student Government President also serve as trustees.

Information about each Trustee is available online at: <https://www.usf.edu/board-of-trustees/about/trustees.aspx>

USF Trustees:

[William Weatherford, Chair](#)

[Michael E. Griffin, Vice Chair](#)

[Charbel J. Barakat](#)

[Sandra Callahan](#)

[Michael Carrere](#)

[N. Rogan Donnelly](#)

[Oscar Horton](#)

[Sumit Jadhav](#)

[Lauran Monbarren](#)

[Shilen Patel](#)

[Fredrick Piccolo](#)

[Melissa Seixas](#)

[David Simmons](#)

USF Administration:

USF President: Rhea Law, J.D.

Website: <https://www.usf.edu/president/index.aspx>

[President's Cabinet](#)

USF Provost & Executive Vice President for Academic Affairs: Prasant Mohapatra, Ph.D.

Website: <https://www.usf.edu/provost/>

[Academic Leadership Team](#)

Executive Vice President for USF Health: Charles Lockwood, M.D.

[USF Health Leadership](#)

Regional Chancellor - USF. St. Petersburg Campus: Christian E. Hardigree, J.D.

Interim Regional Chancellor - USF Sarasota-Manatee Campus: Brett Kemker, Ph.D.

Vice Provost for Academic Planning: Kashuk Dutta, Ph.D.

Vice President for Student Success: Cynthia DeLuca

For additional Administrative areas, visit <https://www.usf.edu/about-usf/administrative-units.aspx>

Office of Graduate Studies Senior Administration

Reference USF Policy 11-001 - <https://usf.app.box.com/v/usfpolicy11-001>

Dean, Office of Graduate Studies	Ruth Bahr, Ph.D.
Campus Assistant Dean, St. Petersburg Campus	Donna Knudsen, Ph.D.
Campus Assistant Dean, Sarasota-Manatee Campus	Sandra Stone, Ph.D.

USF Graduate Liaisons

USF - Dean, Office of Graduate Studies	Ruth Bahr, Ph.D.
USF - St. Petersburg Regional Chancellor	Christian Hardigree, J.D.
USF - St. Petersburg Campus Assistant Dean	Donna Knudsen, Ph.D.
USF - Sarasota-Manatee Interim Regional Chancellor	Brett Kemker, Ph.D.
USF - Sarasota-Manatee Campus Assistant Campus	Sandra Stone, Ph.D.
USF Health Executive Vice President	Charles J. Lockwood, M.D., MHCM
USF Health	Janice Zgibor, RPh, Ph.D.

College Deans

Bellini College of Artificial Intelligence, Cybersecurity and Computing	Sudeep Sarkar, Ph.D, Interim Dean
College of Arts and Sciences	Elizabeth Spiller, Ph.D.
College of Behavioral and Community Sciences	Julie Serovich, Ph.D.
Muma College of Business	David Blackwell, Ph.D.
College of Design, Art, and Performance	Chris Garvin, M.F.A.
College of Education	Jenifer Jasinski Schneider, Ph.D. - Interim Dean
College of Engineering	Levi Thompson, Ph.D.
Patel College of Global Sustainability	Govindan Parayil, Ph.D.
College of Graduate Studies	Ruth Bahr, Ph.D.
College of Marine Science	Thomas K. Frazer, Ph.D.
Morsani College of Medicine	Charles J. Lockwood, MD, MHCM
Taneja College of Pharmacy	Jay Wolfson, DrPH, JD, Interim Dean
College of Nursing	Usha Menon, Ph.D., RN, FAAN, FSBM
College of Public Health	Sten Vermund, M.D., Ph.D.
Judy Genshaft Honors College	Charles Adams, Ph.D.
Libraries	Todd Chavez, M.A.
Undergraduate Studies	Allison Crume, Ph.D.

College Graduate Associate Deans (EGAD)

- <http://www.grad.usf.edu/graduate-coordinators.php>

Bellini College of Artificial Intelligence, Cybersecurity and Computing	Ken Christensen, Ph.D.
College of Arts and Sciences	Valerie (Jody) Harwood, Ph.D.
College of Behavioral and Community Sciences	Jennifer Lister, Ph.D.
Muma College of Business	Timothy Heath, Ph.D.
College of Design, Art, and Performance	Barton Lee
College of Education	William Black, Ph.D.
College of Engineering	Kyle Reed, Ph.D.
Patel College of Global Sustainability	Kebreab Ghebremichael, Ph.D.
College of Graduate Studies	Ruth Bahr, Ph.D.
College of Marine Science	David Naar, Ph.D.
Morsani College of Medicine	Michael Barber, D.Phil.

College of Nursing
Taneja College of Pharmacy
College of Public Health

Douglas Haladay, Ph.D.
Brittany Hay, Ph.D., DNP, APRN, ANP-BC, FNP-BC
Erini Serag, PharmD
Janice Zgibor, Ph.D.

USF Graduate Council

Graduate Council is an official body of the [USF Faculty Senate](#) and works closely with the USF Office of Graduate Studies. Per the [Bylaws to the Constitution of the Faculty of the University of South Florida](#), the USF Graduate Council (GC) advises the Provost and the Executive Vice President for USF Health or their designees on principles, policies, and procedures affecting graduate education at USF.

2025-2026 Leadership:

Chair:	Vrushank Dave
Vice-Chair:	Ingrid Bahner
Secretary:	TBA
Policy/Fellowship Committee:	William (Bill) Campbell
Curriculum Committee:	Derek Wildman
Graduate Studies Liaison:	Carol Hines-Cobb

For the most current list of members, please refer to the website <https://www.usf.edu/graduate-studies/faculty-and-staff/graduate-council/council-members.aspx>

Selected USF Policies and Resources

Campus Alcoholic Beverages Policy: [USF Policy 30-023 Alcohol & Drugs Policy](#)

As an open public university, USF does not prohibit the legal consumption of alcohol on its campuses. We recognize that as part of a well-planned and structured program, the serving and consumption of alcohol may take place. Therefore, the intent of this Policy is to establish guidelines and procedures for the legal and responsible use of alcohol at USF campus events. The use of alcoholic beverages by members of the USF community is at all times subject to the applicable alcoholic beverages laws and ordinances of the State of Florida, and the city and county of each USF campus. No person may sell, furnish, or give alcohol to any person under the legal drinking age defined by Florida law.

Center for Career and Professional Development

The Center for Career and Professional Development provides USF students with comprehensive career planning and job search services. A team of experienced professionals is available to help with both online and in-person career coaching, career exploration, job and internship tools, and related resources to currently enrolled USF students and our alumni. The Center also provides information on employment opportunities and creates venues where students can network and interview with local, state, national and international employers. For convenience, offices are located on all three campuses:

Offices:

Tampa Campus

Website: <https://careers.usf.edu>
Email: TPA-Careers@usf.edu
813-974-2171
Center for Career and Professional Development
4202 E. Fowler Ave., SVC 2088
Tampa, FL 33620

St. Petersburg Campus

Website: <https://careers.usf.edu/channels/st-petersburg/>
Email: Stp-careers@usf.edu

727-873-4129
Office: SLC 2300

Sarasota-Manatee Campus

Website: <https://careers.usf.edu/channels/sarasota-manatee/>
Email: sar-careers@usf.edu
941-359-4703
Office: B 128

Center for Victim Advocacy and Violence Protection

The Center for Victim Advocacy provides free and confidential services to USF students, faculty, and staff. We serve any individual who has experienced crime, violence, or abuse on or off-campus, regardless of whether it happened recently or in the past.

Website: <https://www.usf.edu/student-affairs/victim-advocacy/>
Email: va@usf.edu

Office: (813) 974-5756
24/7 Victim Helpline: (813) 974-5757

4202 E Fowler Avenue, SVC 2057
Tampa, Florida 33620

USF Policy 0-610 Drug-Free Workplace - <https://usf.app.box.com/v/usfpolicyo-610>

The unlawful manufacture, distribution, possession, or use of alcohol or a controlled substance is prohibited on property of or in connection with any of the activities of USF. No employee/student is to report to work/class while under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol. Any employee or student determined to have violated this policy shall be subject to disciplinary action for misconduct. Violation of this policy by an employee/student will be reason for evaluation/treatment for a drug/alcohol use disorder or for disciplinary action up to and including termination/expulsion in accordance with applicable collective bargaining agreements, policies, and procedures, or referral for prosecution consistent with local, state, and federal law.

Equal Opportunity: Discrimination and Harassment - <https://usf.app.box.com/v/usfpolicyo-007>

Office of Veteran Success

The Office of Veteran Success provides specialized programs and services to over 8,000 veterans, eligible dependents, active duty service members, and members of the Selected Reserve on all three USF campuses. We are a one-stop shop for anything that you, a military connected student, may need.

Although we also assist dependents, our main goal is to help veterans in whatever capacity necessary for success with educational and career goals. This may include helping with admission to the school, navigating VA benefits, graduating, or finding employment opportunities. For a list of service and programs go to: <https://www.usf.edu/student-affairs/veterans/about-us/index.aspx>

Tampa Campus Office of Veteran Success

Website: <http://www.usf.edu/student-affairs/veterans/>
Email: ovs@usf.edu
813-974-2291

Office of Veteran Success
4202 E Fowler Ave, ALN 241
Tampa, FL 33620

St. Petersburg Campus

Website: <https://www.stpetersburg.usf.edu/resources/military-and-veteran-success/index.aspx>
Email: usfsp-va@usf.edu

727-873-4467

Military and Veterans Success Center
USF St. Petersburg, TER 301/302
140 7th Ave. S
St. Petersburg, FL 33701

Sarasota-Manatee Campus

Website: <https://www.sarasotamanatee.usf.edu/campus-life/campus-resources/veterans-success/index.aspx>
Email: sm-veteransuccess@usf.edu
941-359-4291

Ombuds Office

The Ombuds Offices at USF are confidential, impartial, independent, and informal resources for students who wish to convey their experiences at USF to explore alternatives for resolving problems or complaints through informal means. The mission of the Ombuds Office is to facilitate fair and equitable resolution processes that promote student success. Each campus has an ombuds or an ombuds liaison. Students from any USF campus can schedule a face-to-face, telephone, or Teams appointment by calling or emailing us. If you choose to email the Student Ombuds Office, please do so with the understanding that communication by email may not be confidential. Contacting us by phone is best.

Website: <https://www.usf.edu/student-affairs/ombuds/>
Email: ombuds@usf.edu
(813) 974-0835

Student Accessibility Services

In accordance with Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act, the Americans with Disabilities Act and the ADA Amendments Act, the University of South Florida provides reasonable classroom accommodation for otherwise qualified students who have documented disabilities. Creating an accessible environment is a collaborative process that involves the office of Students with Accessibility Services, our students, and all faculty and staff. Students who utilize accommodations often share stories about their academic success and the positive impact of accommodations. Students seeking accommodation must register with the Student Accessibility Services Office. Students requesting substitution of departmental graduation requirements will need to contact the chair of their department and will be requested to submit documentation to SAS to support their request for an exception.

Tampa Campus

Website: <https://www.usf.edu/student-affairs/student-accessibility/>
Email: sas-info@usf.edu

813-974-4309 (Office)
813-974-7337 (Fax)

4202 E. Fowler Avenue, SVC 1133
Tampa, FL 33620

St. Petersburg Campus

Website: <https://www.usf.edu/student-affairs/student-accessibility/>
Email: stp-sas@usf.edu
727-873-4837 (Office)
727-873-4828 (Fax)

140 7th Avenue South SLC 1203
St. Petersburg, FL 33701

Sarasota-Manatee Campus

Website: <https://www.usf.edu/student-affairs/student-accessibility/>

Email: sas-sar@usf.edu

941-359-4714 (Office)

8350 N. Tamiami Trail B130A

Sarasota, FL 34243

Title IX Policy: www.usf.edu/title-ix

Office of Compliance & Ethics

Website: <https://www.usf.edu/compliance-ethics/>

titleixreports@usf.edu

813-974-8616

4202 E. Fowler Ave, ALN 172

Tampa, FL 33620

Tobacco and Smoke Free University: [USF Policy 06-026](#)

Smoking, tobacco use, and use of related products is prohibited on all property owned, leased or operated by USF. This includes, but is not limited to, all indoor and outdoor areas and properties. Additionally, no smoking and/or tobacco products will be sold or advertised on the USF Tampa campus. This Policy applies to all faculty, staff, students, vendors and visitors. The President or designee may allow smoking in specific designated areas of campus for clinical treatment purposes, including smoking cessation programs, or research-related purposes.

University Libraries

Website: <https://www.lib.usf.edu/>

Tampa

813-974-2729

4101 USF Apple Drive

Tampa FL 33620

St. Petersburg

727-873-4123

140 7th Avenue South

St. Petersburg, FL 33701

Sarasota-Manatee

941-359-4225

8350 N. Tamiami Trail C203B

Sarasota, FL 34243

The University Library for the Tampa campus offers access to an extensive selection of print and electronic resources, including books, maps, e-journal, e-books, and countless databases. There is also a collection of audio/visual materials including videos, CDs, DVDs, and even LPs. Students and faculty also have access to specialized research assistance and information literacy instruction from our librarians. Assistance is available from research and reference librarians either by appointment, on-line via our website, by phone, or in a classroom setting.

The University Library for the St. Petersburg campus (<https://lib.stpetersburg.usf.edu/home>) is home to the Nelson Poynter Memorial Library, and serves as a partner in teaching, learning and research. The St. Petersburg campus Library connects students and faculty to

a variety of information sources, innovative opportunities, and diverse perspectives.

For instructions on how to access all USF Libraries resources from off-campus, visit our Distance Learning LibGuide (<http://usfsm.libguides.com/distance>).

The University Library for the Sarasota-Manatee campus (<https://lib.usf.edu/sarasotamanatee/>) offers students, faculty, and staff access to the extensive holdings of the University Libraries. Our librarians provide reference and research assistance in all courses of study and can help you to better organize and execute your search for the things you need to get the job done.

In addition to the University Libraries, there are three special libraries.

On the Tampa campus is the Shimberg Health Sciences Library (<https://libraries.health.usf.edu/Home>), serving the needs of USF Health, consisting of the Colleges of Medicine, Nursing, Pharmacy, Physical Therapy, and Public Health; and the Louis de la Parte Florida Mental Health Institute (FMHI) Research Library (<https://www.usf.edu/cbcs/fmhi/>), serving the College of Behavioral and Community Sciences. The Jane Bancroft Cook Library (<https://www.ncf.edu/library/>) serves as a joint-use facility shared by New College and the Sarasota-Manatee campus.
